



Admissions-2025

(PhD - 2nd Intake)

PROSPECTUS

ADVANCED STUDIES & RESEARCH BOARD
UNIVERSITY OF KARACHI

Message



Prof. Dr. M. Khalid Iraqi
Vice Chancellor

Dear Prospective Postgraduate Research Students!

I extend a very warm welcome to all of you for your decision to join the University of Karachi for your postgraduate research journey. Your decision to pursue research studies from one of the leading public sector universities of Pakistan will prove to be a journey of transformation in the real sense.

The University of Karachi offers a vibrant research culture, where innovation, creativity, and critical thinking culminate. Being a multidisciplinary university that offers postgraduate degree programs in a variety of disciplines, research scholars are encouraged to share their unique perspective and set of skills, contributing to the rich tapestry of research. We are committed to provide you with an environment where you can learn to question, accept challenges, find solutions to problems, and make impactful contributions to your field of study.

With a focus on collaborative approach to research, we promote interdisciplinary projects that allow our research students to explore new horizons and address complex global challenges from a multitude of perspectives. In order to encourage our research scholars to collaborate with others, we organize workshops, seminars, and conferences to provide them the required exposure and multiple opportunities for collaboration.

Since embarking on a postgraduate research program is a journey of discovery, perseverance, and growth, it requires dedication, curiosity, and a passion for learning. As the Vice-Chancellor of the University of Karachi, I assure you that our institution is dedicated to providing the support and resources you need to succeed.

We look forward to welcoming you to University of Karachi with the hope that you will produce groundbreaking research in your specific field of inquiry. Wish you all the best!

Message



Prof. Dr. Anila Amber Malik
Director
Postgraduate Admission Committee

I welcome all the potential research scholars to the postgraduate programs offered in different disciplines at the University of Karachi. A university with a rich history of research tradition has produced eminent research scholars and renowned scientists in diverse fields and the legacy continues, as the university is committed to unlocking your research potential as prospective researchers at postgraduate level.

With a focus on contemporary trends in research, the postgraduate programs offered at the University of Karachi provide rigorous exposure to research that is required for successful completion of the specific postgraduate degree programs. I assure you that being part of the research community of the University of Karachi will prove to be an intellectually stimulating experience for you, as the interactions with the academicians and research scholars will enrich your experience and broaden your horizon as a researcher.

Being one of the largest public sector universities of the country, the postgraduate programs offered at the University of Karachi are diverse and multidisciplinary in nature. The courses designed for postgraduate programs across various disciplines aim to enhance your research skills. Besides this, our highly qualified faculty, with extensive research experience, is available to provide the supervision needed to produce quality research. If you want to excel in the research field of your interest, then the University of Karachi is the right place to join.

ADVANCED STUDIES & RESEARCH BOARD

UNIVERSITY OF KARACHI

Members of the Advanced Studies and Research Board

Chairman

Prof. Dr. Khalid M. Iraqi

Vice-Chancellor

Prof. Dr. Anila Amber Malik

Director, Postgraduate Admission Committee

MEMBERS:

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Prof. Dr. Zaeema Asrar Mohiuddin	Dean, Faculty of Management & Administrative Sciences
Prof. Dr. Harris Shoaib	Dean, Faculty of Pharmacy & Pharmaceutical Sciences
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Prof. Dr. Nasir Sulman	Dean, Faculty of Education
Prof. Dr. Farida Islam	Dean, Faculty of Medicine
Prof. Dr. Bilquees Gul	Dean, Faculty of Science Dean (Look-After), Faculty of Engineering
Barrister Zeeshan Adhi	Dean, Faculty of Law

Nominees of the Syndicate

Prof. Dr. Anila Amber Malik	Department of Psychology
Prof. Dr. Intikhab Ulfat	Department of Physics
Prof. Dr. Asma Manzoor	Centre of Excellence for Women's Studies

Nominees of the Academic Council

Prof. Dr. Basit Ansari	Department of Health, Physical Education & Sports Sciences
Prof. Dr. Uzma Ashiq	Department of Chemistry
Prof. Dr. Taseer Ahmed Khan	Department of Physiology

Professors Emeritus

Prof. Dr. Atta-ur-Rahman, FRS	International Centre for Chemical & Biological Sciences (ICCBS)
Prof. Dr. Muhammad Qaiser	Former Professor, Department of Botany
Prof. Dr. Manzoor Ahmed	Department of Philosophy
Prof. Dr. Zafar Saeed Saify	Former Professor, Department of Pharmaceutical Chemistry

Registrar

Prof. Dr. Imran A. Siddiqui	Registrar
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INTRODUCTION

University of Karachi established in 1951, is one of the oldest institutions of higher education of Pakistan. It offers rigorous and vibrant graduate and post-graduate degree programs in the Faculties i.e. Arts & Social Sciences, Education, Engineering, Islamic Studies, Law, Management & Administrative Sciences, Medicine, Pharmacy & Pharmaceutical Sciences, and Science. The research and the teaching programs are supervised by about 400 qualified faculty members. These postgraduate programs are offered in 56 teaching departments and 21 research institutes and centers.

University of Karachi offers its graduate and post-graduate students well equipped laboratories, digital library and video-conferencing facilities in a multi-disciplinary environment. It is committed to uphold its tradition of producing top-quality graduates in cutting-edge areas of Business and Management Sciences, Bio-Medical & Engineering Sciences, Technologies, Social and Natural Sciences. The programs are designed to match the emerging needs of industries and research and development organizations, both in the public and private sectors.

During the last five years, University of Karachi has awarded more than 2000 MS (Surgery), MD (Medicine), MPhil, ME, LL.M and PhD degrees. Presently, approximately 5000 students are enrolled in MS (Surgery), MD (Medicine), MPhil, ME, LL.M. and Ph.D, programs. Faculty members at the University of Karachi are engaged in pursuing research in various disciplines and publish extensively in journals of international repute.

University of Karachi provides excellent opportunities to its postgraduate students and faculty members for scholarships, linkages, trainings and collaboration with the world's top universities in research projects with the universities/institutions/centers in the technologically advanced countries.

FACULTIES

- 1. Faculty of Arts & Social Sciences**
- 2. Faculty of Education**
- 3. Faculty of Engineering**
- 4. Faculty of Islamic Studies**
- 5. Faculty of Management &
Administrative Sciences**
- 6. Faculty of Pharmacy & Pharmaceutical
Sciences**
- 7. Faculty of Science**

DEPARTMENTS / INSTITUTES / CENTRES

FACULTY OF ARTS & SOCIAL SCIENCES	
1.	Arabic
2.	Economics
3.	History
4.	International Relations
5.	Islamic History
6.	Library & Information Science
7.	Mass Communication
8.	Persian
9.	Philosophy
10.	Political Science
11.	Psychology
12.	Sindhi
13.	Social Work
14.	Sociology
15.	Urdu

FACULTY OF EDUCATION	
1.	Education
2.	Teacher Education
3.	Special Education

FACULTY OF ENGINEERING	
1.	Chemical Engineering

FACULTY OF ISLAMIC STUDIES	
1.	Islamic Learning
2.	Quran & Sunnah

FACULTY OF MANAGEMENT & ADMINISTRATIVE SCIENCES	
1.	Public Administration
2.	Business Administration
3.	Commerce

FACULTY OF PHARMACY & PHARMACEUTICAL SCIENCES	
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1.	Pharmacognosy
2.	Pharmaceutics
3.	Pharmaceutical Chemistry

FACULTY OF SCIENCE	
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1.	Agriculture & Agribusiness Management
2.	Applied Chemistry & Chemical Technology
3.	Applied Physics
4.	Biochemistry
5.	Biotechnology
6.	Botany
7.	Chemistry
8.	Computer Science
9.	Food Science & Technology
10.	Genetics
11.	Geography
12.	Geology
13.	Physical Therapy
14.	Mathematics
15.	Microbiology
16.	Physics
17.	Physiology
18.	Zoology

INSTITUTES / CENTRES	
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1.	Dr. A. Q. Khan Institute of Biotechnology & Genetic Engineering (Biotechnology)
2.	Dr. Panjwani Centre for Molecular Medicine & Drug Research (Molecular Medicine)
3.	HEJ Research Institute of Chemistry (Chemistry)
4.	Dr. M. Ajmal Khan Institute of Sustainable Halophyte Utilization (Botany)
5.	National Nematological Research Centre (Nematology)
6.	Dr. Zafar H. Zaidi Centre for Proteomics (Biochemistry)
7.	Institute of Space Science & Technology
8.	Center of Excellence for Women's Studies
9.	Institute of Marine Science
10.	Institute of Environmental Studies
11.	Centre for Plant Conservation

ADMISSION REQUIREMENTS AND PROCEDURE FOR DOCTOR OF PHILOSOPHY (PhD)

Eligibility Criteria

- a) At least 18 years of studies M.Phil, M.Pharm, M.S, MBA (with 4 years BBA), (with research work of six credit hours) or equivalent qualification in the relevant field from HEC recognized University/Institution. There is no requirement to submit Equivalence certificate for the graduates of Public Sector Universities.

One Ph.D seat is especially allocated for the special person from each department / Centre / Institute.

The admission on special persons' reserved seats is granted only after the medical examination and verification from the Social Welfare Department, Government of Sindh and / or civil surgeon.

b) CGPA

- a) For admission in the PhD programs, a minimum CGPA of 3.0 (out of 4.0 in the semester system) or 60% (in the annual system) in the MPhil / equivalent degree being considered for admission, is required, whether such degree was obtained from Pakistani or foreign universities.
- b) If the CGPA/Percentage is not mentioned on the transcript, the candidate must produce equivalent weightage from the parent university.
- c) The students having strong demonstrated interest in obtaining PhD degree, but their CGPA is below 3.00 (minimum 2.6 CGPA) (out of 4.0 in the semester system) or 60% marks (in the annual system) in the most recent degree obtained, may be admitted to a PhD program after fulfilling the following requirements:
- i. Shall study additional courses of 9-12 CH of level 7 taking a zero semester at admission awarding university/HEI/DAI and score minimum 3.00 out of 4.00 GPA, and
 - ii. The admission committee is satisfied that the applicant's knowledge of primary area (level 7) has sufficiently prepared him or her to undertake the course of studies of the doctoral program.
 - iii. These requirements shall be in addition to any other requirements set in this policy for admission to a PhD program.

c) Intradisciplinary Qualification

The intradisciplinary admission may only be allowed, if:

- a) **Departmental Research Committee allows, and**
- b) The applicant has a strong interest in pursuing a PhD in a different discipline.
- c) **The applicant has passed GRE-Subject/Equivalent Test with minimum 60% marks in the discipline of admission and has taken 6-9 CH of deficiency courses of level 7.**
- d) The admission committee is satisfied that the applicant's knowledge of the primary area (level 7) has sufficiently prepared him or her to undertake the course of study of the doctoral program (or, in the opinion of the admissions committee, the preparation can be deemed satisfactory by taking a few additional courses after starting the program).

Admission Procedure (PhD)

1. All candidates will be required to submit the following documents along with the Entrance Test Application Form:
 - i. Consolidated transcript / marks certificate / degree of the last examination.
 - ii. Matric / O levels Certificate
 - iii. Computerized National Identity Card.
 - iv. Recent photograph.
 - v. Paid Fee Voucher

2. Appearance in Karachi University Entrance Test 2025 (KUET-2025) is mandatory for all applicants who wish to seek admission in Ph.D. program to be conducted by relevant departments/centers/institutes of the University of Karachi.

3. (a) The test shall comprise of the following sections:

Section-I Subject knowledge	80%
Section-II English and Communication Skills	20%

- (b) Candidates will be required to score at least 60% marks in each section of KUET-2025 to be eligible for consideration for the **provisional admission**.
- (c) If a candidate has already qualified the International GRE (subject), GAT/HAT (subject) he/she will be exempted from subject test component of KUET 2025. The validity of International GRE (subject) is 5 years and GAT/HAT (subject) is for two years. The passing score is 60%. However, the candidate has to appear in Karachi University Entrance Test 2025 (KUET-2025) English test component, moreover, interview will be mandatory.

Note: Qualifying the Karachi University Entrance Test (KUET 2025) is no guarantee for admission.

4. All the students who qualify the Karachi University Entrance Test 2025 (KUET-2025) will be required to appear in person for an interview to be conducted by the respective Departmental Research Committee (DRC) to finalize the admission procedure. Distribution of interview marks are given in **Annexure-I**.

Provisional Admission

Applications for provisional admission will be considered on the basis of eligibility, merit, availability of seats and supervisors. Final admission list will be prepared by the DRC, according to the marks secured in the Interview that will be given **50% weightage**. (See Annexure-I)

Submission of Forms for Admission

Candidates selected for provisional admission will be required to complete admission form along with the submission of the following documents:

1. Two recent photographs, duly attested by the Chairperson / Director of the Departments/Institute/ Centers concerned.
2. Attested Photocopies of Mark-sheet, Certificates / degrees from S.S.C. to M.Phil. / MS (with research of six credit hours) or the prerequisite exam.
3. Attested photocopy of Computerized National Identity Card.
4. In case of foreign students, NOC from HEC and the Ministry of Education, Economic Affairs Division and Ministry of Foreign Affairs, Government of Pakistan, Islamabad and a copy of valid visa and passport.
5. Certificate from the Equivalence Committee, University of Karachi, in case the accreditation status of the prerequisite degrees is not clear.
6. The Admission & Tuition fee is mentioned in **Annexure-II**.

Duration of PhD

The duration of PhD is minimum of three (03) and maximum of eight (08) years from the date of provisional admission. No further extension will be given. Moreover minimum duration for Ph.D. thesis submission is three (3) years from the date of synopsis submission in ASRB.

Course Work for PhD

1. All selected students will be required to complete minimum 18 credit hours course work.
2. Candidates are required to attend at least 75% classes of each course.
3. The student will submit a research proposal according to the approved format of the ASRB through proper channel.

Comprehensive Examination

4. Following the completion of coursework, every PhD student shall be required to pass the comprehensive examination to be granted candidacy as a PhD researcher, with the provision that the student failing to pass the comprehensive exam, shall be allowed to retake the exam once.

Appointment of Research Supervisor

Faculty members of University of Karachi/ASRB/HEC approved supervisors may be appointed as research supervisors.

Evaluation of PhD Research Thesis

During the research, the student must publish research paper/s from the thesis as per HEC-policy before the submission of PhD thesis in the ASRB Section duly verified by QEC, University of Karachi.

The thesis shall be evaluated by two foreign examiners as per HEC policy. The Ph.D. degree will be awarded by the ASRB subject to the positive reports from the Research Supervisor, two foreign examiners and a successful public defense with an external examiner.

PhD ADMISSIONS – 2025

SCHEDULE

1.	Date of Advertisement	Sunday, December 07, 2025
2.	Issuance & submission of Entrance Test Forms (Form and Fee Voucher can be downloaded for KU website and submitted to the respective department)	December 08, 2025 to December 15, 2025
3.	List of eligible candidates for KU Entrance Test will be displayed on KU website and Departmental notice boards	December 24, 2025
4.	Collection of Admit Cards by the candidates eligible for KU Entrance Test from the office of the Department concerned	December 26, 2025
5.	Karachi University Entrance Test for Ph.D. will be conducted at the relevant department.	SUNDAY December 28, 2025
6.	List of successful candidates of Karachi University Entrance Test will be displayed on KU website.	January 05, 2026
7.	Interview of Successful Candidates at their respective departments/ centers/ institutes	January 06, 2026 to January 09, 2026
8.	Final Merit List of successful candidates for provisional admission will be displayed on KU website	January 16, 2026
9.	• Issuance of Admission Form and Voucher by Postgraduate Admission Office • Submission of provisional admission forms, payment of fees (Voucher duly endorsed by Postgraduate Admission Office) and documents to the Postgraduate Admission Office	January 19, 2026 to January 29, 2026
10.	Commencement of Semester	February 02, 2026

ACADEMIC CALENDAR - 2026

FIRST SEMESTER

Teaching	February 02, 2026	June 02, 2026
Semester Examinations	June 08, 2026	June 15, 2026
Semester Break	June 16, 2026	June 30, 2026

SECOND SEMESTER

Teaching	July 01, 2026	October 30, 2026
Semester Examinations	November 02, 2026	November 10, 2026
Semester Break	November 11, 2026	November 30, 2026

Comprehensive Examination	February 02, 2027
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ADVANCED STUDIES AND RESEARCH BOARD UNIVERSITY OF KARACHI

INTERVIEW CRITERIA FOR PhD						
	Research, Knowledge, Experience and Aptitude			Oral Communication	Proposed Research Plan/Project	Total
	Research Experience (thesis/project)	Research Dissemination (poster/presentation)	Publication			
Max Marks	10	05	05	15	15	50
Marks Obtained						
Comments						
Total Marks Obtained in the interview out of 50						
Marks obtained from Test (50%)						
Total marks obtained in the interview (50%)						
Name of Student:						
Form No:						
Department/Institute/Center						

Name and Signature of DRC Members

1. _____

4. _____

2. _____

5. _____

3. _____

6. _____

Name and Signature of the Chairperson

Admissions – 2025 (PhD 2nd Intake)

FEE STRUCTURE

Department/Program	Processing Fee	Admission Fee (PhD)	PhD Semester Fee (Per Six Months)	PhD Thesis Evaluation/ Viva Examination Fee
Islamic History	8,000	30,000	88,000	85,000
Philosophy	8,000	30,000	88,000	85,000
Arabic	8,000	30,000	88,000	85,000
Sindhi	8,000	30,000	88,000	85,000
Persian	8,000	30,000	88,000	85,000
Urdu	8,000	30,000	88,000	85,000
Islamic Learning	8,000	30,000	88,000	85,000
Quran & Sunnah	8,000	30,000	88,000	85,000
Centre of Excellence for Women's Studies	8,000	30,000	88,000	85,000
Social Work	8,000	30,000	88,000	85,000
Education	8,000	30,000	88,000	85,000
History	8,000	30,000	88,000	85,000
Special Education	8,000	30,000	88,000	85,000
Library and Information Science	8,000	30,000	88,000	85,000
Political Science	8,000	30,000	88,000	85,000
International Relations	8,000	30,000	99,000	85,000
Mass Communication	8,000	30,000	99,000	85,000
Economics	8,000	30,000	99,000	85,000
Sociology	8,000	30,000	99,000	85,000
Teacher Education	8,000	30,000	99,000	85,000
Botany	8,000	30,000	99,000	85,000
Physics	8,000	30,000	99,000	85,000
Geography	8,000	30,000	99,000	85,000
Genetics	8,000	30,000	99,000	85,000
Institute of Marine Science	8,000	30,000	99,000	85,000
Zoology	8,000	30,000	99,000	85,000
Geology	8,000	30,000	99,000	85,000
Applied Physics	8,000	30,000	99,000	85,000
Biochemistry	8,000	30,000	99,000	85,000
Microbiology	8,000	30,000	99,000	85,000
Biotechnology	8,000	30,000	99,000	85,000
Institute of Space Science and Technology	8,000	30,000	99,000	85,000
Physiology	8,000	30,000	99,000	85,000
Applied Chemistry and Chemical Technology	8,000	30,000	99,000	85,000
Food Science and Technology	8,000	30,000	99,000	85,000
Chemistry	8,000	30,000	99,000	85,000

Commerce	8,000	30,000	99,000	85,000
Mathematics	8,000	30,000	99,000	85,000
Dr. M. Ajmal Khan Institute of Sustainable Halophyte Utilization	8,000	30,000	99,000	85,000
Dr. A. Q. Khan Institute of Biotechnology & Genetic Engineering	8,000	30,000	99,000	85,000
Centre for Plant Conservation	8,000	30,000	99,000	85,000
Chemistry (HEJ)	8,000	30,000	99,000	85,000
Dr. Zafar H. Zaidi Center for Proteomics	8,000	30,000	99,000	85,000
Institute of Environmental Studies	8,000	30,000	121,000	85,000
Agriculture and Agribusiness Management	8,000	30,000	121,000	85,000
Chemical Engineering	8,000	30,000	121,000	85,000
Computer Science	8,000	30,000	121,000	85,000
Karachi University Business School	8,000	30,000	121,000	85,000
National Nematological Research Centre	8,000	30,000	121,000	85,000
Psychology	8,000	30,000	132,000	85,000
Public Administration	8,000	30,000	132,000	85,000
Dr. Panjwani Center for Molecular Medicine and Drug Research	8,000	30,000	132,000	85,000
Pharmaceutics	8,000	30,000	132,000	85,000
Pharmacognosy	8,000	30,000	132,000	85,000
Pharmaceutical Chemistry	8,000	30,000	132,000	85,000
Physical Therapy	8,000	30,000	165,000	85,000

Foreign Students			
Department/Program	Processing Fee	Admission Fee	Semester Fee (Per Six Months)
<u>For the Faculties:</u> • Arts & Social Sciences • Management & Administrative Sciences • Islamic Studies • Education • Science • Engineering • Pharmacy & Pharmaceutical Sciences	8000	30,000	200,000